

NOTES
Regular School Committee Meeting
Monday, December 20, 2021
6:30 PM

To be held at the Howard Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall.

Also presented on Zoom.

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/99954546677>

The MHS and Middle School Orchestra performed a selection of holiday favorites at 6:00PM in the Chambers.

6:34 PM - Mayor Breanna Lungo Koehn: Roll Call for Attendance of Members and the Student Representatives

Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: 7 present/ 0 absent

Student Representative: on zoom

6:35 Salute the Flag

Consent Agenda Motion to approve Melanie McLaughlin/Paul Ruseau 7/0 approved

- Approval of Bills/Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Meeting Minutes, 12.6.2021

Report of Subcommittees

1. Special Education Subcommittee Meeting Minutes, 12.16.2021 - *Melanie McLaughlin*
Motion to table: MM/PR 7/0 tabled

Report of the Superintendent

1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent**

Thanks to the students who performed and their teachers: Haley Rello, Emma Baptist and Sophia Chang

2. COVID-19 Update - David Murphy, Assistant Superintendent of Finance & Operations

Link to slides

Uptick in positivity in testing the program. Health services reiterate the message that students and staff with symptoms are required to stay home. We will adjust testing dates when we return in January. We will stick with early week testing in anticipation of uptick.

Participation rate is strong. Actual participation is about 70%. 12% have not signed up to participate in the testing program. We will be holding additional vaccination clinics in partnership with the Board of Health. Generally we are encouraged by vax rates among staff and high school population. 5 to 11 year old rate of vax is low. We believe that the numbers are higher but that they have not yet gotten their second doses or sent in documentation yet.

Clinics: every Wednesday hopefully starting January 5. At Medford High School. We will be phoning families to encourage participation. More formal announcements will be coming.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Letter from Rebecca Gutlin, Roberts Elementary School: increasing concerned that notices are sent by email and by facebook only in English. They should go out in backpacks and be translated. Effective outreach is essential.

Dave Murphy: Continuous improvement is our goal when it comes to communication. Translations are usually provided in messages coming from Central Office. When it comes to backpacks, we don't have the capacity to put everything in the backpack. We don't want to get to a place that the backpack becomes a spam folder.

Jenny Graham : Are we considering school day vaccination clinics?

Dave Murphy: Yes. We will start with the afters chool program but will move to school day at some point. When we have the staffing, we will pursue it.

3. Update on Kindergarten Enrollment - Assistant Superintendent of Elementary Education, Suzanne Galusi

Link to slides:

23 new K students since September. More in queue. Most at the McGlynn Elementary. We may have to create additional first grade classrooms next year. 357 current K students right now/105 students indicated language other than English/58 of those receive EL programming. All were tested.

Kindergarten registration will open Monday, January 10, 2022. Bridges to K dates: Jan 13, Feb 8 at 6:30 Virtual. March 9th session will be in person at MHS.

Melanie McLaughlin: * additional students in subseparate classrooms. Why are they separated?

Suzanne: Because of the way they are recorded in School Brains

Melanie: In the breakdown by classroom, is everything included?

Suzanne: This report is focused on K. I will have the data manager run the report for the whole district.

Marice Edouard-Vincent: We will create the report called out by program.

Melanie: I would just want it to be consistent across the district in the report.

Paul Ruseau: I noticed that for the incoming Kindergarteners where we are at the capacity, what is the thinking for next year?

Suzanne G: The plan is to offer their neighborhood schools. If they would like to stay where they are assigned, we need to consider siblings and transportation.

Paul Ruseau: It won't be a one size fits all approach correct?

Suzanne G: Correct. Lots of things to consider.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: How long does it take to process the new students in the queue in the PIC?

Suzanne: Depends on a lot of variables such as medical clearance and other forms of documentation for the students.

Paul Ruseau: Can these documents be mailed to us?

4. Special Recognition of School Committee Member Paulette Van der Kloot retiring after 32 years of service to Medford Public Schools. - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent

Marice Edouard-Vincent: 7:03 PM

32 years...For 32 years the superintendent of the Medford Public Schools has enjoyed the counsel, support, and supervision of someone who has come to embody public service in this community and is one of the longest serving School Committee members in the Commonwealth of Massachusetts.

For 32 years the teachers and staff of the Medford Public Schools have enjoyed the presence, enthusiasm, and loyalty of someone who afforded this city her time, energy, and leadership.

For 32 years the parents and caregivers of Medford's children and young adults have had a voice in the governance of their children's school system because of someone who has continually put the needs of her community before her own.

For 32 years the residents of Medford have enjoyed access to their city's school system through a representative who has worked to make this school system worthy of the great community we serve.

For 32 years the students of the Medford Public Schools have benefited from an elected official whose sole focus has been working to build a school system that will position them for success, achievement, and fulfilling lives.

And for the last four years, as the city's superintendent of schools, I have enjoyed the friendship, guidance, and mentorship of the person whose service we honor tonight, Ms. Paulette Van der Kloot.

Paulette hails from Long Island, New York, coming here to study at Tufts University's Fletcher School of Law & Diplomacy. 41 years ago she married Bob Van der Kloot, (also a Medford transplant), and together they raised three daughters: Katie, Megan and Liz, each of whom are Mustang alumni. Additionally, Paulette and Bob are dedicated grandparents to their (3) grandsons: Harry, Charlie and Ezra.

Starting with her work with the Medford Home and School Association, Paulette's support for this district has been steadfast. She was elected 32 years ago, the day after giving birth to her youngest daughter, with her famous slogan of "Give a Hoot, Vote Van der Kloot," which resonated with this community. For the next three decades she personified that slogan by supporting every Mustang sport, activity and club the district had to offer.

Paulette's vision for the school system was one that served the whole child, and every child. Through her advocacy for the arts, early education programs, and vocational education to name a few, we are a district that is much closer to that vision than we would have been without her leadership and service. And so tonight, we say thank you.

We know we could not fit in one room all the people who want to say thank you. But the following guests are with us both to say thank you and as representatives of everyone else who Paulette has worked with and all of the good work they have done together. Please hold your applause until the end.

Former Mayor Stephanie Muccini Burke
Former Superintendent of Schools, Dr. Phil Devaux

Former Superintendent of Schools, Roy Belson

I worked with Paulette Van der Kloot for 28 years. She has been a steady, insightful, strategic member. Her energy has enabled many programs in MPS. I am grateful for her feedback. She was never a rubber stamp - she was a strategic partner. First President of Citywide Home and School Association getting the small schools to work together. Supporter of Early Ed. Building the future Committee. Many capital improvements fueled by Paulette Van der Kloot's support. Expansion of the vocational programming.

Fought hard to maintain art, foreign language and music programs. CCCR and Global Scholars high in priority list. MHS reaccruited three times while Paulette Van der Kloot was in office. No SC attended more student programs than Paulette. Attended all the Malden/Medford thanksgiving football games. Fought for the underdog. Supported equity and social justice. Paulette Van der Kloot has been a terrific SC member but also is an exemplary human being. Earned our respect. Hard act to follow.

Former Assistant Superintendent of Schools, Beverly Nelson
Former Assistant Superintendent of Schools, Diane Caldwell
School Committee Attorney Howard Greenspan

Former School Committee Members:

Patty Brady
Jack Buckley, Former Building the Future Project Manager
Ann Marie Cugno
Erin DiBenedetto
Sharon Guzik
Fred Laskey, Current Director, Massachusetts Water Resources Authority
Ed Nolan

Beth Fuller (holding a Paulette Van der Kloot sign)

I first met Paulette Van der Kloot around 1989 outside the Dame School. We served together for 6 years. You had to make friends with the school secretaries and the custodians because they knew everything. No cell phones, no laptops, no social media. We did the best we could to get people involved and into meetings. Paulette Van der Kloot supported hiring the K aides for the extended day programs. Parent involvement has increased since then.

Bill O'Keefe

Former Building the Future Co-Chairpersons: Rick Orlando & Patricia McDonough
Former Medford High School Principal, Dr. Paul Krueger

Former Principal/Director, Medford Vocational Technical High School, Dr. Heidi Riccio

Also with us this evening our representatives from our school buildings.

Former Asst. Supt. Diane Caldwell, Shannon Demos, Doreen Andrews, Farrah Lalli, Nancy Sherman Hudson, Diane Guarino, Paul D'Alleva

Diane Caldwell: Love for students and families of Medford has always been front and center. I can't ever remember your missing any meetings. Supporter of the arts for as long as I remember. As a teacher and administrator, I have always felt comfortable seeking your opinion and advice. It is bittersweet for us. Thank you for all the years you gave to Medford. Happy retirement.

Paul D'Alleva: Remarks. You have seen teachers spend many years as educators move into educational leadership roles. Big proponent of investing in the future of MPS. Truly special person. Gave a poster ma

Paulette sees each of our individual schools as communities, and like all communities they require investment and care. Paulette has modeled that for each of us.

At this time to begin our presentations I would like to ask the representatives from our schools to come forward to offer some tokens of appreciation, which will be presented by two individuals who have worked with Paulette for a significant portion of her service to Medford, former Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell and MHS Principal Paul D'Alleva.

Also with us this evening is someone who knows well both how challenging serving on a school committee can be, and how unique it is for someone as talented as Paulette to be willing to do it for 32 years.

Please welcome from the Massachusetts Association of School Committees, Executive Director Glenn Koocher.

Paulette Van der Kloot and Ann Marie Cugno were board members of MASC. Paulette always had the courage to be at odds with the majority. Rational person to bring calm to the chaos. Paulette was a person of honor and integrity. Gave the Distinguished Service for 2021.

Thanks to City Councillor Zack Bears who is with us this evening.

Many of our elected officials who could not be here in person, but wanted to send along their commendations, to share those along with their own thoughts we will now turn the floor over to Paulette's current colleagues, starting with Members McLaughlin and Graham.

[Citations from fellow SC members, who also share their own words]

Sen. Jehlen by Members Melanie McLaughlin and Jenny Graham

Melanie McLaughlin: Thank you for your service. 32 years is remarkable. Ballparking 800 hours of meetings.

Jenny Graham: State Senate citation.

Citation from Rep. Katheryn Clark by Member Paul Ruseau

Paulette always made me feel so comfortable. When I think about what Paulette brought to the SC: her historical knowledge and calmness.

Citation from Gov. Baker by Member Mea Mustone

I have appreciated working with you during my time on SC.

Sen. Markey by Member Kathy Kreatz

Thank you for your service and for your friendship. Your knowledge and your kindness and your remarkable memory have been so helpful. You were a great mentor to my son with your volunteer program. I will miss you and probably reach out to you.

Jenny Graham

Two years ago when I was campaigning, I spoke with a woman whose children went to school with Paulette's children. This woman said, that before Paulette, parents were not members of the School Committee. She is the reason they are members today.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn presents the chair (read inscription).

From the bottom of my heart thank you for running this last time for SC. These last two years were the toughest two years of my time in politics. You have calmly and rationally solved so many problems. You knew when you needed to reach out to help. I look up to you as a friend and colleague. Thank you for all you have done for our kids. I wish you the best of luck with your retirement.

And on behalf of both the administration and the entire Medford Public Schools community, I have the honor of presenting this final gift, which has an inscription here that I will read, but first and foremost, let me just say thank you, Paulette. I know that your love of Medford and our schools will continue, and please know that our team is counting on your service and involvement to continue as well.

Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent presents the engraved bell (read inscription)

We value you very deeply and hope you will continue to provide counsel as committee member emeritus.

And now finally, please welcome a pillar of the Medford community and the Medford Public Schools, Paulette Van der Kloot.

Paulette Van der Kloot:

Thank you for being with me tonight. I never expected to be speaking to a group of masked people. There were times people may have wished I was masked. The job of the SC person rests largely on words and the ability to persuade. Welcome to Sharon Hays, our new member. Thank you to Suzi Weiss and Lisa Evangelista for helping put tonight together. Our dog Pippi woke us up - it was "Hoot, Hoot". My owl appeared every two years without fear. It was a sign that it was time to give up my owl. Last March beat the record. The longest meeting went past 2am for a budget session. There are so many people I need to acknowledge. Mayor McGlynn had the habit of thanking so many people and leaving his family to the end. Thanks to my husband, Bob. Thank you to Kate, Megan and Liz for putting up with a mom on SC. I know that there was one upside when you were one of the first to know about snow days. I am so fortunate to have the help and support of my friends over the years. Liz was born on my first election day. Showing pictures on the screen of campaign photos. The second force was my campaign manager, Dick O'Meara. Dr. Lori Davidson, treasurer. Wordsmith/photographer: David Lock. Boss Marie Johnson at Winchester Hospital. I am truly blessed to have the support of friends and families. I thank the people of Medford. I have worked with SC members from across Massachusetts. I thank Glenn

Koocher from MASC and the other SC members who I have been able to work with. I say thank you to Howard Greenspan, lawyer. I have had the opportunity to work with three Mayors, McGlynn, Muccini-Burke, and Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn. I have worked with so many SC members some for a long time and some for short.get list from Paulette. And thank you to my current colleagues, Melanie, Mea, Jenny, Kathy, and Paul. Thanks to the Building the Future Committee. Thanks to all the dedicated teachers and administrators who have devoted their lives to our children. During COVID, so many have been superheroes. Thank you to the administrators. Thank you for all the reports except MCAS reports - purgatory is made up with MCAS reports. I have worked with three superintendents. Carmen is here with us as a Superintendent resident - she wants to be a superintendent. Hardest job ever. Thank you Roy for starting so many great programs like Family Network and CCSR. Thank you to Marice for getting our students as soon as possible during COVID. Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent keep on going. In leaving, I have two thoughts: toughest time during the committee was having to lay off staff and teachers. Please spend ESSER funds wisely so you don't have to lay off in the future. Divisiveness in our nation is a challenge. Build bridges.

In honor of Bud Kelley, I have blue and white running through my veins.

Continued Business

1. Tabled on 12/06/2021:

Given the substantial limitation of the use of out-of-school suspensions approved unanimously by the Medford School Committee on October 14, 2020; and given this change allowed for nearly a year of planning for implementation by district leadership; the Superintendent will present the plans that were developed in that year prior to this change, including how principals and assistant principals were trained on changes they have implemented at the start of this school year to comply with this change in policy; the number of detentions, Saturday detentions, in-school suspensions, and any out-of-school suspensions issued from the start of the 2021-2022 school year through October 31 disaggregated by school and grade level; professional development offered to any staff and the percentage of staff by type and school level that participated; challenges that are being worked through; recommendations the School Committee should consider to assist with implementation of the policy; and future plans for continuing this work to ensure all students have access to the education they have a right to under the Massachusetts Constitution.

- Offered by Paul Ruseau

PR: Tabled again until January 3. Seconded by Melanie: 7/0 motion is tabled.

New Business

1. The Medford Public Schools COVID-19 weekly testing program will be implemented in the Kids Corner program to cover staff and children. In light of the fact that these children are unable to be vaccinated at this time, testing will occur as many days each week as necessary to ensure all

children in the program are tested weekly. If some children are not participants of the program on the scheduled testing day, rapid tests can be used to supplement the normal testing program.

- *Offered by Paul Ruseau, Kathy Kreatz, and Mea Mustone*
Jenny Graham/Kathy Kreatz Motion to approve: 7/0 motion approved.

Condolences

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of William J. “Billy” Finn, a former security guard at Medford High School.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Margaret L. Camuso, cousin to former School Committee Member Paul Camuso and Jeanine Camuso, Director of Human Resources for MPS.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Elaine Fiumara, mother of former McGlynn School Paraprofessional Colleen Barrett.

The Medford School Committee expresses its sincere condolences to the family of Paul D. Sanford, husband of Marjorie Sanford, former administrative assistant at the Roberts Elementary School.

Next Meeting

- **Monday, January 3, 2022: Regular School Committee Meeting** - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/95833589191>

Adjournment: Motion to adjourn: Melanie/Paulette Van der Kloot 7/0 8:08 PM

Reception in the Chambers to celebrate the retirement of Paulette Van der Kloot, member of the Medford School Committee for 32 years immediately following the meeting.